

Yifei He, Dr. phil., M.Sc.

Postdoctoral Researcher | Translational Neuroimaging Lab, Department of Psychiatry and Psychotherapy, Philipps University Marburg

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EDUCATION

- 2010 – 2016** **Dr. phil. in Linguistics, Johannes Gutenberg University Mainz, Germany**
Thesis: Interactive processing within and beyond sentence-level: An ERP investigation of simple and complex Chinese sentences | summa cum laude | Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Matthias Schlesewsky
- 2007 – 2009** **M.Sc. in Clinical Linguistics, European Master in Clinical Linguistics (EMCL): University of Milano-Bicocca, Italy | University of Groningen, the Netherlands | University of Potsdam, Germany**
Thesis: Semantics, syntax, and distance: An ERP study on Chinese classifiers | excellent (A) | Supervisor: Dr. Laurie Stowe
- 2002 – 2006** **B.A. in English Linguistics and Literature, Renmin University of China, China**

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

- 2016 – present** **Postdoctoral Researcher (Wissenschaftlicher Mitarbeiter) & Principal Investigator of third-party funded projects, Translational Neuroimaging Lab, Department of Psychiatry and Psychotherapy, Philipps University Marburg, Germany**
Advisors: Prof. Dr. Benjamin Straube, Prof. Dr. Tilo Kircher
- 2012 – 2016** **Pre-doctoral researcher (Wissenschaftlicher Mitarbeiter), Department of Psychiatry and Psychotherapy, Philipps University Marburg, Germany**
Advisor: Prof. Dr. Benjamin Straube
- 2010 – 2012** **Doctoral student (Stipendiat), Department of Linguistics, Johannes Gutenberg University Mainz, Germany**
Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Matthias Schlesewsky

CAREER BREAKS

- 2021 – 2022** **Parental leave (full-time, 12 months, 10/2021 – 10/2022)**
- 2015** **Parental leave (full-time, 2 months, 04/2015 – 05/2015)**

RESEARCH FUNDING

Competitive research funding secured: €703,000 as PI and €113,800 as co-PI.

External / third-party funding

- 2025 – 2027** **Research Project funded by the von Behring-Röntgen-Stiftung: Dysfunctional efference copy mechanisms in schizophrenia: investigating effects on behaviour and neural mechanisms across space and time (72_0003)**
Volume: €100,000 | PI: **Dr. Yifei He** with Prof. Dr. Bianca van Kemenade (Giessen)
- 2024 – 2027** **DFG-funded Individual Research Grant: The predictive coding account of schizophrenia: Dysfunctional interaction across linguistic levels (HE8029/5-1)**
Volume (own share): €227,000 | PI: **Dr. Yifei He** with Dr. Lars Meyer (MPI CBS Leipzig / University of Münster)

2020 – 2023	DFG-funded Individual Research Grant: Multistage integration during co-speech gesture integration: a systematic investigation combining EEG and fMRI (HE8029/2-1) Volume: €250,000 PI: Dr. Yifei He , co-PI: Prof. Dr. Benjamin Straube
Intramural funding	
2025 – 2027	Intramural Research Project 'DigiStrucMed' funded by Hannover Medical School: Can the machine detect information we cannot? Developing an algorithm that can diagnose patients with functional tic-like movement disorder using machine learning Volume: €9,800 PI: Prof. Dr. Kirsten Müller-Vahl, Prof. Dr. Lars Schmidt-Thieme Co-PIs: Dr. Simon Schmidt, Johannes Burchert, Dr. Yifei He
2024 – 2026	Mini-Grant funded by LOEWE (DYNAMIC): Use of NLP Models to Analyze Linguistic Patterns and Their Relationship to Depression: A Longitudinal Investigation of Symptom Trajectories Volume: €10,000 PIs: Katrin Leinweber, Dr. Frederike Stein, Dr. Yifei He
2024 – 2026	Cooperation Research Project funded by University Hospital Giessen Marburg (UKGM): The role of N-methyl-D-aspartate glutamate receptor (NMDAR) during sensory and semantic prediction in schizophrenia: a cross-sectional EEG investigation on brain oscillations Volume: €116,000 PI: Dr. Yifei He Co-PIs: Prof. Dr. Arne Nagels (Mainz), Prof. Dr. Christoph Mulert (Giessen)
2020 – 2022	Cooperation Research Project funded by University Hospital Giessen Marburg (UKGM): Developing and investigating the neurobiological basis for social-cognitive intervention programme for patients with schizophrenia Volume: €104,000 PI: Dr. Florian Bitsch Co-PIs: Dr. Yifei He , Prof. Dr. Benjamin Straube

PUBLICATIONS AND CURRENT WORK

Summary:

26 peer-reviewed journal articles (8 first authorship, 9 senior authorship)
 9 preprints or manuscripts submitted/under revision (8 senior authorship)
 630 citations, h-index 16, i10-index 19.

Preprints or manuscripts submitted / under revision

Xue, Q., Liu, Y., Yuan, M., Zhang, Z., Kircher, T., Chen, L. *, & **He, Y. *** (submitted). Subject preference as a flexible interpretive heuristic in thematic role assignment. PsyArXiv. (* shared senior authorship).

Huang, J., Tan, R., Feng, R., Straube, B., Zhang, S., & **He, Y.** (2026). How social exclusion shapes intertemporal choice: self-control resources as the central bridge. PsyArXiv.

Chen, L., Yang, G., Qu, X., Li, D., Zhao, C., Wu, J., Zeng, K., **He, Y. ***, Hartwigsen, G. *, Chen, R. *, & Friederici, A. D. * (2026). Transcranial Ultrasound Stimulation Unravels the Causal Role of the Left Inferior Frontal Gyrus in Syntactic Processing. Research Square rs-8717654. (* shared senior authorship).

Tumanyants, A., Straube, B., Mulert, C., & **He, Y.** (2026). Local predictive context modulates evidence accumulation and boundary separation during semantic priming. PsyArXiv.

Liu, Y., Kircher, T., Chen, L., **He, Y. ***, & Straube, B. * (2026). The impact of co-speech gesture on sentence memory and metacognitive confidence. PsyArXiv. (* shared senior authorship).

Leinweber, K., **He, Y.**, Büchsenschütz, K., Hofmann, S. G., Kircher, T., & Straube, B. (2025). The relationship between self-reported gesture use and neuropsychological functioning in a transdiagnostic sample of patients with mental disorders. SSRN 5352659.

Huang, J., Straube, B., & **He, Y.** (2025). Dissecting the hierarchy of gesture comprehension: Evidence from a multilevel priming paradigm and drift-diffusion model. PsyArXiv.

Ody, E., Kircher, T., Straube, B. *, & **He, Y. *** (2024). Voluntary action sharpens sensory prediction and facilitates neural processing of contingent sensory stimuli. bioRxiv. (* shared senior authorship).

Sommer, J., Hansen-Schirra, S., Nagels, A., & **He, Y.** (2021). Processing linguistic negation with and without truth-value evaluation: Evidence from N400 and theta oscillations. PsyArXiv.

Peer-reviewed journal articles

26. Leinweber, K., **He, Y.**, Kircher, T., & Straube, B. (2026). Dysfunctional neural processing of object-related speech with semantically unrelated vs related co-verbal gesture in schizophrenia spectrum disorders. *Neuropsychologia*, 233, 109586.
25. Trujillo, J., Straube, B., & **He, Y.** (2026). Discourse context and co-speech gestures jointly shape hierarchical prediction during the processing of a multimodal narrative. *Neurobiology of Language*. Advance online publication.
24. Ody, E., Kircher, T., **He, Y.***, & Straube, B.* (2025). Differential effects of self-initiated, externally triggered, and passive movements on action-outcome processing: Insights from sensory and motor-preparatory ERPs. *European Journal of Neuroscience*, 62(5), e70236. (* shared senior authorship)
23. Huang, J., Feng, R., Straube, B., He, Q., Zhang, S., & **He, Y.** (2025). Transcranial direct current stimulation alleviates the negative impact of immediate and chronic social exclusion on intertemporal decision-making. *Social Cognitive and Affective Neuroscience*.
22. Wei, H., **He, Y.**, Kauschke, C., Scharinger, M., & Domahs, U. (2025). L2-categorisation of linguistic and emotional prosody in German: an EEG study. *Language, Cognition and Neuroscience*, 40(9), 1262–1279.
21. Hermann, A., Benke, C., Blecker, C. R., de Haas, B., **He, Y.**, Hofmann, S. G., ... & Kirchner, L. (2024). Study protocol TransTAM: Transdiagnostic research into emotional disorders and cognitive-behavioral therapy of the adaptive mind. *BMC Psychiatry*, 24(1), 657.
20. Osorio, S., Straube, B., Meyer, L.*, & **He, Y.*** (2024). The role of co-speech gestures in retrieval and prediction during naturalistic multimodal narrative processing. *Language, Cognition and Neuroscience*. (* shared senior authorship)
19. **He, Y.**, Sommer, J., Hansen-Schirra, S., & Nagels, A. (2024). Multivariate pattern analysis of EEG reveals nuanced impact of negation on sentence processing in the N400 and later time windows. *Psychophysiology*, e14491.
18. Ody, E., Kircher, T., Straube, B.*, & **He, Y.*** (2023). Pre-movement event-related potentials and multivariate pattern of EEG encode action outcome prediction. *Human Brain Mapping*, 44, 6198–6213. (* shared senior authorship)
17. Ody, E., Straube, B.*, **He, Y.***, & Kircher, T.* (2023). Perception of self-generated and externally-generated visual stimuli: Evidence from EEG and behavior. *Psychophysiology*, 60, e14295. (* shared senior authorship)
16. Yue, J., Wang, P., Li, J., Li, Z., Liang, X., & **He, Y.** (2022). Short-term habituation of auditory N1 in spoken word-forms is modulated by phonological information. *Brain Sciences*, 12(10), 1279.
15. Wang, P., **He, Y.**, Maess, B., Yue, J., Chen, L., Brauer, J., ... & Knösche, T. R. (2022). Alpha power during task performance predicts individual language comprehension. *NeuroImage*, 260, 119449.
14. Cuevas, P.*, **He, Y.***, Steines, M., & Straube, B. (2022). The processing of semantic complexity and co-speech gestures in schizophrenia: A naturalistic, multimodal fMRI study. *Schizophrenia Bulletin Open*, 3(1). (* shared first authorship)
13. Meyer, L., Lakatos, P., & **He, Y.** (2021). Language dysfunction in schizophrenia: Assessing neural tracking to characterize the underlying disorder(s)? *Frontiers in Neuroscience*, 15, 640502.
12. **He, Y.**, Steines, M., Sammer, G., Nagels, A., Kircher, T., & Straube, B. (2021). Modality-specific dysfunctional neural processing of social and non-social information in schizophrenia. *NeuroImage Clinical*, 29, 102568.
11. Cuevas, P., **He, Y.**, Billino, J., Kozasa, E., & Straube, B. (2021). Age-related effects on the neural processing of semantic complexity in a continuous narrative: Modulation by gestures already present in young to mid-aged adults. *Neuropsychologia*, 151, 107725.
10. **He, Y.**, Luell, S., Muralikrishnan, R., Straube, B., & Nagels, A. (2020). Gesture's body orientation modulates the N400 for visual sentences primed by gestures. *Human Brain Mapping*, 41(17), 4901–4911.
9. Wroblewski, A., **He, Y.**, & Straube, B. (2020). Dynamic causal modelling suggests impaired effective connectivity in patients with schizophrenia spectrum disorders during gesture–speech integration. *Schizophrenia Research*, 216, 175–183.
8. Hou, J., **He, Y.**, Zhao, X., Thai, J., Fan, M., Feng, Y., & Huang, L. (2020). The effects of job satisfaction and psychological resilience on job performance among residents of the Standardized Residency Training: A nationwide study in China. *Psychology, Health & Medicine*, 1–13.
7. Cuevas, P., Steines, M., **He, Y.**, Nagels, A., Culham, J., & Straube, B. (2019). The facilitative effect of gestures on the neural processing of semantic complexity in a continuous narrative. *NeuroImage*, 195, 38–47.
6. Straube, B., Wroblewski, A., Jansen, A., & **He, Y.** (2018). The connectivity signature of co-speech gesture integration: The superior temporal sulcus modulates connectivity between areas related to visual gesture and auditory speech processing. *NeuroImage*, 181, 539–549.

5. He, Y., Nagels, A., Schlesewsky, M., & Straube, B. (2018). The role of gamma oscillations during integration of metaphoric gestures and abstract speech. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 9, 1348.
4. He, Y., Steines, M., Sommer, J., Gebhardt, H., Nagels, A., Sammer, G., Kircher, T., & Straube, B. (2018). Spatial-temporal dynamics of gesture–speech integration: A simultaneous EEG–fMRI study. *Brain Structure and Function*, 223(7), 3073–3089.
3. He, Y., Steines, M., Sammer, G., Nagels, A., Kircher, T., & Straube, B. (2018). Action-related speech modulates beta oscillations during observation of tool-use gestures. *Brain Topography*, 31(8), 838–847.
2. He, Y., Gebhardt, H., Steines, M., Sammer, G., Kircher, T., Nagels, A., & Straube, B. (2015). The EEG and fMRI signatures of neural integration: An investigation of meaningful gestures and corresponding speech. *Neuropsychologia*, 72, 27–42.
1. Straube, B., He, Y., Steines, M., Gebhardt, H., Kircher, T., Sammer, G., & Nagels, A. (2013). Supramodal neural processing of abstract information conveyed by speech and gesture. *Frontiers in Behavioral Neuroscience*, 7, 120.

ACADEMIC PRESENTATIONS

Summary:

1 Keynote talk
12 Invited talks

Keynote talk

2023 **Keynote talk, Processing co-speech gestures: a neural perspective, Gesture and Speech in Interaction (GESPIN2023)**
Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics / Donders Institute / Radboud University, Nijmegen, the Netherlands

Invited talks

2025 **How action leads to perceptual preference**
East China Normal University & New York University Shanghai, Shanghai, China

2025 **Processing Multimodal Language**
Hong Kong Polytechnic University, Hong Kong, China

2025 **Understanding the processing of multimodal language from a neural–behavioral perspective**
Chinese University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong, China

2023 **The effect of co-speech gestures on speech perception and language comprehension (virtual talk)**
ISGS-Hong Kong, Hong Kong Polytechnic University, Hong Kong, China

2021 **Investigating multimodal language processing with multimodal neuroimaging methods (virtual talk)**
Max Planck Institute for Psycholinguistics, Nijmegen, the Netherlands

2021 **How gesture integrates and interacts with speech during online comprehension (virtual talk)**
Centre for Language Evolution, The University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, UK

2019 **Exploring gesture–speech interaction using multimodal neuroscientific methods: a translational perspective**
Max Planck Institute for Human Cognitive and Brain Sciences, Leipzig, Germany

2019 **Investigating gesture–speech interaction using multimodal neuroscientific methods**
Johannes Gutenberg University Mainz, Mainz, Germany

2018 **Gesture–speech interaction in time, frequency, and space**
Albert-Einstein Hospital, São Paulo, Brazil

2018 **Unveiling the brain dynamics of gesture–speech interaction using EEG, fMRI, simultaneous EEG–fMRI, and tDCS**
Zhejiang University of Technology, Hangzhou, China

2018 **Investigating human cognitive functions and dysfunctions with neuroscientific methods**
Harbin Institute of Technology, Harbin, China

2017 **Hand gestures alert auditory cortices to process foreign language**
Johannes Gutenberg University Mainz, Mainz, Germany

Other talks (first/senior author)

2025 **Discourse Context and Co-Speech Gestures Jointly Modulate Neural Language Processing**
International Society of Gesture Studies (ISGS), Nijmegen, the Netherlands

2025 **Motor prediction sharpens early visual representations, independent of prior expectations (first author: Edward Ody)**
Psychologie und Gehirn (PUG), Würzburg, Germany

2023 **Temporal generalization reveals a close relationship between the preparation of self-induced action and the perception of its sensory outcome**
Conference of the European Society for Cognitive Psychology (ESCAP), Porto, Portugal

2022 **Perception of self-generated and externally-generated visual stimuli: Evidence from EEG and behavior (first author: Edward Ody)**
Conference of the European Society for Cognitive Psychology (ESCAP), Lille, France

2020 **Polarity effects in negated sentences with and without truth value reversal: Evidence from N400 and theta oscillations (first author: Johanna Sommer)**
The Processing of Negation and Polarity Workshop, Berlin, Germany

2018 **Gamma band oscillations mediate comprehension of metaphoric co-speech gestures**
The Conference of Experimental Psychologists (TEAP), Marburg, Germany

2016 **Gesture–speech integration in time and space: a combined EEG–fMRI study**
International Society of Gesture Studies (ISGS), Paris, France

2014 **Subject relative clause preference in Chinese: processing relative clauses with two gaps**
Annual Meeting of the German Linguistic Society (DGfS), Marburg, Germany

2013 **The missing power: Language mediates sensorimotor-related beta oscillations during online comprehension of different types of co-speech gestures**
Tilburg Gesture Research Meeting (TIGER), Tilburg, the Netherlands

2011 **Prominence beyond sentence: an ERP study of ‘pro-drop’ constructions in Chinese**
Workshop of Experimental Pragmatics, Mainz, Germany

Posters (first author / presenter)

2025: Psychologie und Gehirn (PUG), Würzburg, Germany; 2024: Cognitive Science Society meeting (CSS), Rotterdam, the Netherlands; 2024: Psychologie und Gehirn (PUG), Hamburg, Germany; 2019: Ling-Cologne Multimodal Language, Cologne, Germany; 2014: International Society of Gesture Studies (ISGS), San Diego, USA; The Conference of Experimental Psychologists (TEAP), Giessen, Germany; 2013: Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP), Marseille, France; Robert Sommer Award Symposium (RSA), Giessen, Germany; 2011: Neurobiology of Language (SNL), Annapolis, USA

Posters (co-author / senior author)

2025: Neurobiology of Language (SNL), Washington DC, USA; 2025: International Society of Gesture Studies (ISGS), Nijmegen, the Netherlands; 2025: Cognitive Neuroscience Society Annual Meeting (CNS), Boston, USA; 2024: Psychologie und Gehirn (PUG), Hamburg, Germany; 2023: Conference of the European Society for Cognitive Psychology (ESCAP), Porto, Portugal; 2022: Centre for Vision Research Conference, York, Canada; 2022: New Sounds 2022, Barcelona, Spain; 2022: Speech Prosody 2022, Lisbon, Portugal; 2019: International Conference on Education, Economics and Management Research (ICEEMR), Singapore; 2017: Organization for Human Brain Mapping (OHBM), Vancouver, Canada; 2016: Robert Sommer Award Symposium (RSA), Giessen, Germany (n = 2); 2010: Organization for Human Brain Mapping (OHBM), Barcelona, Spain; 2009: Formal vs. Processing Explanations of Processing Phenomena Conference, York, UK

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

2019 **Best Poster Award, Ling-Cologne 2019 Conference in Multimodal Language**
€500

2010	Pro Geistes- und Sozialwissenschaften Stipendium, Johannes Gutenberg University Mainz €30,000
2007	Erasmus Mundus Master's Scholarship, European Union €24,000

RESEARCH COLLABORATIONS

Current

Benjamin Straube (Marburg, Germany)
 Lars Meyer (Leipzig/Münster/Mainz, Germany)
 James Trujillo (Amsterdam, the Netherlands)
 Bianca van Kemenade (Giessen, Germany)
 Matthias Scharinger (Marburg, Germany)
 Tilo Kircher (Marburg, Germany)
 Roy Mukamel (Tel Aviv, Israel)
 Kirsten Müller-Vahl (Hannover, Germany)
 Daniel Kaiser (Giessen, Germany)
 Yan Gu (Essex, UK)
 Christoph Mulert (Giessen, Germany)
 Harry Luyao Chen (Hong Kong, China)
 Leon Krocze (Regensburg, Germany)
 Jinxing Yue (Harbin, China)

Past

Ulrike Domahs (Marburg, Germany)
 Arne Nagels (Mainz, Germany)
 Silvia Hansen-Schirra (Mainz, Germany)
 Peter Lakatos (Orangeburg, USA)
 Xudong Zhao (Shanghai, China)

STUDENT SUPERVISION

Doctoral theses

present	Tugce Dalmis, PhD, advisor with Bianca van Kemenade, Psychiatry, Giessen & Marburg von Behring-Röntgen Foundation Dysfunctional efference copy in schizophrenia
present	Yang Liu, PhD, advisor, Psychiatry, Marburg Chinese Scholarship Council The role of gesture in metacognitive memory of sentences
present	Anna Petukhova, PhD, advisor, Psychiatry, Marburg DFG & University Clinic Giessen Marburg Predictive language processing in schizophrenia
present	Junqing Huang, PhD, advisor, Psychiatry, Marburg Chinese Scholarship Council & DFG Drift-diffusion modeling of gesture perception
2025	Johanna Sommer, PhD, advisor, Linguistics, Mainz Mini Graduate School, Johannes Gutenberg University Mainz ERP and oscillatory markers of sentence negation
2025	Huan Wei, PhD, co-advisor with Prof. Dr. Ulrike Domahs, Linguistics, Marburg Konrad-Adenauer-Stiftung ERP study on prosodic processing in L1/L2 German speakers

- 2023** **Edward Ody, PhD, advisor, Psychiatry, Marburg**
IRTG-1901 The Brain in Action | EEG study on multisensory consequences of active vs. passive action in healthy participants and patients with schizophrenia
- 2020** **Paulina Cuevas, PhD, co-advisor with Prof. Dr. Benjamin Straube, Psychiatry, Marburg**
IRTG-1901 The Brain in Action | Neural correlates of gesture–speech interaction with naturalistic data: fMRI investigation of healthy, aging, and schizophrenia populations
- 2020** **Adrian Wroblewski, PhD, co-advisor with Prof. Dr. Benjamin Straube, Psychiatry, Marburg**
Marburg University Research Academy (MARA) | Effective connectivity signature of gesture–speech integration in healthy participants and patients with schizophrenia

Master's theses

- 2020** **Jiayin Li, M.A., co-advisor with Prof. Jinxing Yue, Linguistics, Harbin Institute of Technology, China**
Now PhD student at the University of Reading, UK
- 2019** **Babette Jacobi, M.Sc., advisor, Cognitive and Systems Neuroscience, Marburg**
Now PhD student at Radboud University / Donders Institute, the Netherlands

Internships

- 2022** **Sergio Osorio, internship co-supervision with Dr. Lars Meyer (Leipzig) & Francisco Aboitiz (Santiago, Chile)**
Now Postdoc at UC Davis, USA
- 2021** **Xaver Funk, internship supervision, Cognitive and Systems Neuroscience, Marburg, Germany**
Now PhD student at Leiden University, the Netherlands
- 2019** **Babette Jacobi, internship supervision, Cognitive and Systems Neuroscience, Marburg, Germany**
Now PhD student at Radboud University / Donders Institute, the Netherlands

EDITORIAL AND REVIEW SERVICE

Editorial roles

Frontiers in Language Sciences: Review Editor (from 2023)
Cognitive Processing: Handling Editor (from 2020)
Frontiers in Human Neuroscience: Review Editor (from 2020)

Ad hoc review

Cerebral Cortex; Developmental Psychobiology; Language, Cognition and Neuroscience; Neuropsychologia; NeuroImage Clinical; Frontiers in Psychology; Journal of Neuroscience; IEEE Transactions on Neural Systems & Rehabilitation Engineering; Cognitive Processing; NeuroImage; Brain Research; European Archives of Psychiatry and Clinical Neuroscience; Human Brain Mapping; Biological Psychology; Psychological Medicine; Frontiers in Human Neuroscience; Pragmatics and Cognition; Journal of Clinical Medicine; Brain Sciences; Journal of Integrative Neuroscience; Brain and Language; iScience; Brain and Behavior; Oxford Research Encyclopedia of Neuroscience; Behavioral and Brain Functions; Journal of Experimental Psychology: Human Perception and Performance; Advanced Science; Psychophysiology; IEEE Transactions of Biomedical and Health Informatics; Frontiers in Psychiatry; PLOS Biology; Language and Speech; Frontiers in Developmental Psychology; Journal of Cognitive Neuroscience; Behavioral Brain Research; Neuroscience Letters; Language and Cognition; Acta Psychologica; Neuroscience; PLOS ONE; Psychological Research; Annals of the New York Academy of Sciences; Developmental Science; NeuroImage: Reports; Frontiers in Language Science; Scientific Reports; Journal of Memory and Language; Autism & Developmental Language Impairments; Cognitive Science.